

Hurd's Relief Gains Victory

By Special Correspondent

DENVER, Colo.—Minneapolis moved within one game of clinching a berth in the American Association playoffs by edging Denver 2-1 Friday night in a tense, 10-inning pitchers' battle.

Tommy Hurd, taking over in the last three innings, turned in a sensational relief job to gain the decision over Denver's lefty Ed Donnelly, who went all the way.

Denver fell to fourth place with Wichita taking third place behind the Millers.

Southpaw Dean Stone also hurled brilliantly in his seven innings, allowing only a second-inning home run by Zeke Bella.

That run loomed large, however, until the eighth inning when the Millers tied the score on a single by Pumpsie Green and a double off the rightfield fence by pinch-hitter Harry Malmberg.

The second-place Millers narrowly missed winning — and losing — the game in the ninth.

Hurd got out of trouble by curving a called third strike past Dick Sanders, who protested so vigorously he was ejected by plate umpire Walt Doyle.

Donnelly also became involved in the argument and became so worked up that he momentarily lost poise — which turned out to be fatal. He started the 10th inning by walking Green on four pitches, then settled down and almost got out of his jam.

Malmberg bunted safely. Donnelly wild-pitched the runners to second and third in the process of striking out Lu Clinton.

Art Schult drew an intentional walk to fill the bases before Red Robbins' sacrifice fly to medium center field scored Green with the winning run.

But the Millers still had to sweat a little before notching their third straight victory over Denver, which dealt Minneapolis the same medicine in Minneapolis last week.

AFTER THE BEARS' Gordie Windhorn bunted a pop fly for the first out. Manager Gene Mauch of the Millers decided to go into his pitching maneuvers.

The first move backfired as southpaw-swinging John Blanchard bloomed a single to left against Lefty Tom Borland, who took the mound as Hurd was shifted to third base. Hurd came back to throw a strike to Jim Pisoni and Denver Manager Andy Cohen got into the act by bringing in southpaw-swinging George Wilson.

Hurd had the answer to this as he struck out Wilson with a beautiful curve ball. And just to make it emphatic he struck out Zeke Bella with the same medicine to wrap it up. It was Hurd's fifth strike-out in his three-inning stint.



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ed up a nice gain during Fri-
oka's Dave Sonneman. Anoka

. Tennis

don titleholder and U.S. de-
fender, must face the double-
barrelled shots of Mrs. Fleitz
in today's semi-finals.

The other semi-final pits
two unseeded dark horses